

UTEP Stuns 'Cats To Salvage Split

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walks and back-to-back singles by Villareal and designated hitter Bob Dowing.

Arizona threatened in the fifth and sent Miner starter Jeff Hogan to the dugout. Hogan's replacement was Stringer and that proved the end of the 'Cats for the day.

In the fifth, Hogan gave up a leadoff double to Hassey, a single to Haines and then walked Scott Norris to load the bases. Miner coach Andy Cohen made another of his many trips to the mound Saturday and called on Stringer.

The UTEP right-hander, who beat Arizona State 7-5 a week ago before losing to Arizona Friday, retired three straight batters while allowing but one run to score in the fifth-inning uprising.

In the sixth, Arizona advanced runners to second and third with no outs when Stegman walked and Ben Heise doubled to left field. But Stringer settled down to strike out Thompson and get Hassey on a ground ball to second while the runners held. After Dennis Haines walked to load the bases, Norris slashed a line drive up the middle but Miner second baseman Miller made a diving grab to his right, caught the ball in the web of his glove and ended the rally.

Stringer retired the side in order in the

seventh to save the win for Hogan and was mobbed by his jubilant teammates.

"The key was Stringer coming in and stopping them dead," Cohen said after the game.

Kindall agreed and added, "I thought he (Cohen) might bring Stringer in. I thought he might start him in the second game.

"We had our best hitters up there with men on base and he just shut the door."

In the first game the Wildcats jumped on six Miner pitchers for 11 extra base hits including three home runs and two triples. In addition the UTEP mound corps set a WAC record by walking 16 Arizona batters.

Norris, Arizona's junior right-fielder, set a WAC mark by driving in eight runs in the game. He hit a solo home run in the second inning, added a grand slam home in the third for his ninth round-tripper of the season, knocked in another run with a single in the fourth, forced in a run with a walk in the seventh and added his eighth RBI in the eighth inning when he was hit by a pitch with the bases loaded.

Mark Schimpf pitched six innings and picked up the win for the 'Cats. The 6-2, 192-pound right-hander gave up three runs on four hits while walking four and striking out three to win his 10th game of the year.